

A

The five basic senses



sight



hearing



taste



smell



touch

To express it another way, the ability to see, hear, taste, smell and feel.

B

Sense verbs with adjectives

You **look** tired this evening. [from what I can see]

That man **sounded foreign**. [from another country, from what I could hear]

This cake **tastes** a bit strange.

Fresh bread **smells** wonderful.

This shirt **feels damp**. [slightly wet, often in an unpleasant way]

Language help

The verbs above can all be used as nouns.

*I like **the look of** this hotel.* [the appearance of it]

*I love **the sound of** his voice.*

C

Sense verbs with *like* or *as if/though*

We can describe things using sense verbs with **like** + noun or **as if / though** + clause, but *not like* + adjective (NOT She looks ~~like~~ nice). When we use **like** + noun, we are often describing how similar two things are.

Have you ever had a nectarine? They **look like** peaches.

Did you hear that noise? It **sounded like** an alarm.

That shampoo **smells like** coconut. (also **smells of** coconut)

Don't you think this material **feels like** silk?

That boy **looks as if** he's trying to get over the wall.

I spoke to Isobel. It **sounded as though** they had a good time on holiday.



nectarine



alarm



coconut



silk

Language help

We also use **seem** and **appear** to describe a sense or feeling about someone or something, after we have seen them, talked to them, etc. Before **like** + noun, we usually use **seem**.

*I saw Will and he **seemed/appeared** quite happy. The shop **appears/seems** to be very busy.*

*Amelia said she wanted to travel a bit, which **seems like** a good idea.*

D

Verbs easily confused

If you **look** [look carefully] at the map, you can **see** [are able to see] the church on the left.

They've been **watching** that man for weeks. [paying attention to something, often for a long time]

He ran into me because he wasn't **looking** [paying attention].

I **watched/saw** a film on TV. I **saw** a film at the cinema. (NOT I ~~watched~~ a film at the cinema.)

I **heard** [was able to hear] what she said but I wasn't **listening** [paying attention].

Don't **touch** the oven [put your hand on it]. It's hot!

Just **feel** my feet [put your hand on them to discover something about them]. Aren't they cold?